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Graduate Recruitment Team

Millennium Capital Management (UK) LLP

London

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Graduate Analyst – Trading (Global Fixed Income, Currency and Commodities team) role in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Millennium's commitment to commodities, where natural gas trading drove much of its gains in 2023 and 2024, matches the market I know best.

My work keeps returning to one question: does an apparent edge survive a proper test? I tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries and rejected zero alpha jointly in 48 of 53, with momentum the most persistent anomaly. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, estimates petro-currencies' oil betas from OPEC announcement-day surprises, tests whether Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge make them smaller, kinked or one-sided, and asks whether any beta that remains survives costs and a White reality check. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, I also built a wheat calendar-spread strategy whose weekly backtest returned a Sharpe ratio of 0.76 before costs and 0.28 after, which taught me how quickly turnover erodes an edge.

Hedge funds appeal to me because the distance between an idea and its consequences is short: a research view becomes a position, and the position is marked every day. I take that accountability seriously. As Vice-President and then President of the Strathclyde Poker Society, I taught new members to use the Kelly criterion to work out how many buy-ins their win rate, variance and risk tolerance call for, with a buffer because their edge is only an estimate; a position sized on an uncertain alpha needs the same caution. As Treasurer of the Agricapital Society, which I helped grow to 126 members, I manage its budget and accounts.

Millennium stands out to me because its platform gives individual teams real responsibility for risk, and its commitment to commodities runs deep, from the natural gas trading behind much of its commodities profit in 2023 and 2024 to its \$1.5 billion backing of the Echion Capital commodities spin-out. A graduate role that mixes trading, research and software development across fixed income, currency and commodity markets suits someone whose dissertation links oil and currencies and whose work runs on code.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan